

90-DAY MARKET ENTRY & DISTRIBUTION PLAN

Strategic thesis: Build the distribution network before building the retail network.

Zen is a new entrant into the market and therefore will face headwinds competing as a perfume retailer. It should enter through a strategic WhatsApp-first agent network leveraging brand building through the Zen brand, WhatsApp commerce platform, independent agents and local distribution. A website will be used to support discovery and trust.

This means WhatsApp drives commerce; Website supports discovery and agents provide the physical distribution layer.

1. MARKET & COMPETITIVE POSITION

The market is already crowded around different SKUs from budget to premium, similar price points, rapidly developing physical stores and conventional ecommerce. The preferred opportunity is to compete on accessibility, develop a dense agent network and become a distributed retail rather than compete on matching competitors stores or catalogue breadth.

Competitor	Positioning / brand hierarchy	Indicative pricing	Distribution
FFC	Established national fragrance/reseller platform	Retail ~R40–190; starter R960	15 national warehouses + kiosks; web + call centre
M-Scents	Large catalogue and strong regional physical presence	Retail ~R30–400+; starter R800–R3,750	21 stores, concentrated in KZN; web
Fragrance Boutique	More premium / curated boutique proposition	~R219–419	Physical + web + WhatsApp
Perfumes for Africa	Broad affordable selection / value	~R12–133	Physical + web + WhatsApp
SensoryFX / Sensetek	Manufacturing / B2B supplier	B2B	Centurion / Sandton

Zen's opportunity

- There is no identified competitor that uses WhatsApp first ordering, to support low entry barriers, team commissions and distribution agents..
- Zen's positioning: "Own a perfume business from your phone."
- Core proposition: own-brand fragrance, WhatsApp commerce, income opportunity and distributed retail network.

Brand hierarchy & launch range

Tier	Role	Wholesale	Indicative retail
Budget	Recruitment / impulse	R30–50	R60–100
Signature	Main revenue engine	R80–100	R160–200
Premium / Oud	Margin / gifting	R150–200	R300–400

Launch with 20 SKUs on Budget. This becomes an acquisition product, to test the market, establish credibility and coverage whilst building towards an expansion strategy.

ZEN FRAGRANCES — CHANNEL & DISTRIBUTION STRATEGY

2. CHANNEL ARCHITECTURE

Do not treat every channel as a simultaneous sales channel. Each has a specific job and enters at a different stage.

Stage	Channel	Strategic job
1. Launch	WhatsApp, Agents and Hawkers	Agent acquisition, ordering, reordering, communication
2. Support	Website and Flyers	Brand credibility, catalogue, onboarding and agent locator
3. Expand	Wholesale	Geographic penetration and intense distribution
4. Physical	Stores / kiosks / consignment	Physical trust
5. Scale	Hubs / regional DCs	Lower fulfilment time and increase density

The Zen distribution loop

ZEN BRAND → WHATSAPP → AGENT HUB → LOCAL SELLERS → CUSTOMER

Website = “What is Zen?” | WhatsApp = “How do I buy/sell Zen?” | Agent = “Where can I get Zen locally?”

3. DISTRIBUTION STRATEGY: PRIORITISE AGENTS OVER PHYSICAL PRESENCE

Phase 1 — Agent hubs | Months 1–3

- One strong agent becomes a local distribution node.
- Hawkers / micro-sellers order through WhatsApp using the agent code.
- Zen consolidates paid orders and makes one bulk delivery to the hub.
- The hub distributes locally; the agent becomes Zen's last-mile infrastructure.
- Courier rule: single low-value bottles are not couriered alone. Consolidate orders; target $\geq$ R500 minimum shipped value and ideally $\geq$ R2,000 for free shipping.

Phase 2 — Hub stock | Months 3–6

- Top-performing agents hold 20–50 bottles of fast-moving SKUs.
- Objective: move from order $\rightarrow$ courier $\rightarrow$ customer to local stock $\rightarrow$ same-day fulfilment.

Phase 3 — Town-by-town network | Month 6+

- Build: lead agent $\rightarrow$ local sellers $\rightarrow$ customers.
- Target density, not stores: each meaningful township eventually has a hub and a network of active sellers.

Phase 4 — Regional distribution centres

- Only establish Zen-owned regional infrastructure when order density and economics justify the investment.
- Physical stores, kiosks and DCs should be revenue-funded rather than launch requirements.

4. WHAT LAUNCHES NOW — AND WHAT WAITS

NOW	SUPPORTING	DEFER
WhatsApp ordering & onboarding	Website: brand / catalogue / SEO / agent locator	Physical stores
Identify 10 agents	Flyer / shareable catalogue	Stores / kiosks / consignment
20-SKU own-brand range	Customer discovery	Zen-owned DCs
Hawker / micro-seller pilot	Brand/social proof	Large paid advertising
Bulk-to-hub fulfilment	Agent locator	Large SKU expansion

ZEN FRAGRANCES — 90-DAY EXECUTION PLAN

5. DAYS 0–30 — PROVE THE MODEL WORKS

Objective: prove that people will sell Zen and that the fulfilment loop works.

Workstream	Actions
Product	Identify 20 fast moving SKUs, confirm R30 entry product; packaging, samples;
Infrastructure	WhatsApp live, website live, flyer live, payment and manufacturing flow tested
Distribution	Recruit 10 seed agents - focus Cape Town, Eastern Cape and KZN, recruit first hawker (develop profiles); establish first hub
Marketing	Agent recruitment content; WhatsApp groups; document first testimonials/reviews

Validation: 10 agents → ≥10 first orders → repeat orders beginning.

6. DAYS 31–60 — PROVE REPEATABILITY

Objective: determine what sells, who sells, and whether the model repeats.

- Identify top 10 SKUs and top-performing agents.
- Measure 30-day agent retention and reorder rate.
- Establish 2–3 township hubs.
- Consider Signature products
- Introduce agent referral mechanics and weekly top-seller communication.
- Capture customer reviews, and scent feedback.
- Test small paid acquisition campaigns only after organic conversion is understood.

Validation: Active agents, orders and reorder rate

7. DAYS 61–90 — PROVE SCALE

Objective: create a repeatable acquisition and distribution machine.

Expand from the initial seed network toward 50+ active agents.

Move to other regions including Gauteng - Tembisa, Mamelodi, Alexandra and Katlehong.

Prepare to double down on the Eastern Cape to counter M-Scent expansion once economics are proven.

Holding pattern for KZN because the presence of two strong competitors

8. BOARD-LEVEL DASHBOARD

KPI	30 days	60 days	90 days
Active agents	10	50	100
Monthly orders	20+	150+	300+
Monthly GMV	R10–15K	R75K+	R180K+
Agent reorder rate	Baseline	>30%	-
Average order value	>R500	>R500	>R600
Courier % of revenue	<10%	<8%	<6%

9. VALIDATION / KEY RISKS

Issue	Decision / mitigation
Manufacturing dependency	Confirm private-label inventory model, possibility of signature brand for month 3
No physical presence	Agents will drive testing events and become initial physical presence
No brand recognition	Agents give reviews, consistent packaging from day 1
Courier economics	Bulk-to-hub only; do not courier single budget bottles, bulk costs
WhatsApp payment friction	Use payment links / EFT + POP initially; add card flow as available
Copycat risk	Speed-to-market, agent density and proprietary blends

THE STRATEGIC THRUST: Focus on building the density of the distribution network before building the retail network. Leverage on using WhatsApp commerce and build a dense network of independent local sellers.